

SOURCE TO SOUND

SAVE THE STREAM!

Investigate how pollution left on the ground can be carried into streams and rescue a model stream

TODAY'S STREAM RESCUE

What we will learn:

- Tell pollution from natural stream materials
- Identify different types of pollution
- Explain how litter can reach streams

What we will do:

- Explore a model stream
- Find materials that do not belong
- Remove and sort pollution



WHAT BELONGS IN A STREAM?

A healthy stream is a home for living things – What animals or plants might you find in one?



AND WHAT DOESNT?



WHAT IS POLLUTION?

Pollution is something harmful or out of place that makes the environment dirty or unsafe

Belongs in the stream	Does not belong
• Fish • Plants • Rocks • Natural leaves and twigs	• Plastic trash • Paper litter • Foil wrappers • String • Oil

FROM THE GROUND TO STREAMS

1. Pollution is left on the ground: Trash like plastic or litter is dropped on streets and roads



2. Rain moves the pollution: Rainwater carries and pushes the pollution across the ground

3. Pollution reaches the water: The pollution can enter storm drains, creeks, lakes, and streams



YOUR MISSION

Your team has discovered a polluted stream. Your job is to remove the pollution without disturbing the stream habitat.

1. **Examine every item carefully in the model stream**
2. **Decide whether or not it belongs**
3. **Remove one pollution item at a time**
4. **Identify the type of pollution and place it in the correct sorting cup**
5. **Leave all natural items in place**

WHAT DID WE FIND?

Pollution Type	How Many Did We Find?

BE A STREAM HELPER

How can we keep our streams clean?

Put trash where it belongs: Place wrappers, bottles, papers, and other waste in the correct trash or recycling bin. Trash left on streets and roads can be carried into the water.

Use less plastic: Choose reusable water bottles, utensils, and bags when possible. Fewer single-use plastics means less becomes litter.

Be active and aware! Look out for trash and pollution on sidewalks, streets, and playgrounds. Help clean it up when it is safe and ask an adult before touching anything dangerous

